

segment and tested in the real business environment (Known as UAT – User acceptance testing).

Then based on the feedback from customers, the product/software may be released as it is or with enhancements as per the market's requirement. After the product is released in the market, its maintenance is done for the existing customer base.

Maintenance

Once the customers start using the developed software, the occasional defects and bugs that arise, need to be solved from time to time. Periodically fixing bugs/defects on a production setup is known as maintenance.

There are various models devised which are followed during the software development cycle. These models are known as Software Development Process Models. Each model is suited for different requirements and has its own advantages and disadvantages. It is up to the organisation to decide which models are suited for their needs.

Most popular Process Models are as follows:

- Waterfall Model
- Prototyping
- Incremental Model
- Iterative Model
- Spiral Model
- Rapid application development
- Agile development
- V-Model
- Big Bang Model



User Acceptance Testing decides the fate of your project

So what are the best practices in each of these stages? Before knowing that, let's move on to understanding what happens when these are not followed with some of the best (or worst) examples of what happens in their absence. **d**